

Andrew Martinez

March 12, 2025

IT FDN 130 A Wi 25

Assignment 07

Assignment 07 – Functions

Introduction

In this document I will be discussing the uses functions, and more specifically, user-defined functions.

Uses for UDFs

User-Defined functions, or UDFs, are used when the in-built SQL functions don't cover your use case and you need something that allows for more flexibility than a stored procedure. They allow you the flexibility to create batches of code that you need to run multiple times and that require some sort of input or "parameter". These parameters allow the function to change its output based on a user input.

Scalar vs Inline vs Multi-Statement Functions

A scalar UDF is the most simple kind of UDF, it will always return only a single value. This does not make them less useful, just less complex in form. An Inline UDF is one that returns a whole table of data. Similarly, a Multi-Statement UDF will also return a table, however, it differs in that it is able to run multiple SELECT statements inside of it.

Summary

In summary, this week we learned about the various forms of SQL functions including useful inbuilt ones that can help with data formatting, as well as powerful and flexible User-Defined Functions that allow for custom functions that can adapt to user input.